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■ Responders work amid building rubble following a strike by an Iranian missile in the Israeli city of Bat Yam, yesterday. (Right) A plume of heavy smoke and fire rises from an oil refinery in southern Tehran, after it was hit in an overnight Israeli strike yesterday.



AFP

UAE, world urge restraint amid Iran-Israel conflict

TRUMP PUSHES THE TWO COUNTRIES TO MAKE A DEAL

ABU DHABI

The UAE and Saudi Arabia have strongly condemned Israel's strikes on Iran and have joined the world in calling for de-escalation of tensions amid the ongoing tit-for-tat missile and drone strikes by the two countries, which has raised fears of a wider regional war.

After condemning the Israeli military targeting of Iran during a phone call on Friday with Abbas Araghchi, Minister of Foreign Affairs of Iran, Shaikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, yesterday held telephone conversations with a number of foreign ministers of brotherly and friendly countries. They addressed the repercussions of the current situation on the security and stability of the region and the world, and the ways to intensify efforts to de-escalate tensions and prevent the expansion of the conflict in the Middle East.

Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed Bin Salman held a phone call yesterday with Masoud

The European Union has also voiced 'deepest concern' at the escalation of conflict, calling for restraint to avoid dangers such as a leak of radioactive material.

Pezeshkian, President of Iran. According to the Saudi Press Agency, the Crown Prince expressed his condolences and sympathy to the President and people of Iran as well as the families of those who lost their lives as a result of the Israeli attacks.

Dialogue disrupted

The Saudi Crown Prince stressed that these attacks have disrupted ongoing dialogue aimed at resolving the crisis and have hindered efforts to de-escalate tensions and reach diplomatic solutions. He emphasised the Kingdom's rejection of the use of force to resolve disputes and highlighted the importance of dialogue as the foundation for settling disagreements.

The European Union has also

voiced "deepest concern" at the escalation of conflict, calling for restraint to avoid dangers such as a leak of radioactive material.

US President Donald Trump yesterday urged Iran and Israel to "make a deal" and bring their deadly exchange of strikes to an end. "Iran and Israel should make a deal, and will make a deal," Trump said on his Truth Social media platform, adding that there are "many calls and meetings now taking place" on the issue and that peace could be achieved "soon" between the longtime adversaries.

Iran, meanwhile, announced that mosques, metro stations and schools would serve as shelters from yesterday evening, as Israel's attacks entered a third day with Iranian media saying the death toll from Israeli attacks on Friday and Saturday was at least 128, including women and children, reporting hundreds more wounded.

Iranian missile fire targeting Israel killed at least 10 people overnight, according to authorities, pushing the death toll up to 13 since Iran began its retaliatory strikes Friday, with 380 reported injured.

— Agencies
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UAE's 2024 GDP sees 4% growth; non-oil sectors contribute 75%

Country's non-oil economy records a 5% increase as GDP hits Dh1.776 trillion

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The UAE's real GDP grew by 4 per cent in 2024 to reach Dh1.776 trillion, with non-oil sectors contributing 75.5 per cent of the national economy — a clear sign that diversification efforts are accelerating, according to the latest figures released by the Federal Competitiveness and Statistics Centre (FCSC).

The non-oil economy recorded a 5 per cent growth to reach Dh1.342 trillion, while oil-related activities added Dh434 billion. The data underscores the UAE's shift toward a more sustainable, innovation-driven economic model, aligned with long-term national visions and global competitiveness goals.

Abdulla Bin Touq Al Marri, UAE Minister of Economy, said the strong performance highlights the resilience and positive momentum of the national economy. He noted that the country's strategies to diversify away from oil are "achieving tangible results" and supporting the transition to a knowledge-based economy.

'Sustained success'

"These indicators reflect the sustained success of our economic diversification strategy," he said. "They also bring us closer to achieving the goals of the 'We the UAE 2031' vision — including our target to grow

Dh434b
oil-related activities' contribution to the UAE's GDP

9.6%
transport and storage sector's year-on-year growth rate

GDP to Dh3 trillion by the next decade."

Among the top-performing sectors in 2024, transport and storage led the way with a 9.6 per cent year-on-year growth rate. This was largely attributed to strong air traffic through UAE airports, which handled nearly 147.8 million passengers, an increase of around 10 per cent compared to the previous year.

The construction sector also posted significant gains, expanding by 8.4 per cent, driven by robust investment in infrastructure and urban development. Other high-growth areas included:

- Financial and insurance activities: up 7 per cent
- Hospitality sector (hotels and restaurants): up 5.7 per cent
- Real estate activities: up 4.8 per cent

These sectors are playing a growing role in supporting non-oil GDP and reflect the UAE's push to become a hub for business, finance, tourism, and logistics.

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SPORT

Messi still has got it but needs help as Inter Miami held | P17

Emirates, Etihad, flydubai among world's safest airlines

Air Arabia too ranks high on global list

DUBAI

BY ANUPAM VARMA
Online Editor

Even as the world is trying to come to terms with the Air India disaster that left at least 279 dead, a new ranking has revealed a list of airlines that are considered the world's safest.

According to the latest rankings, revealed by AirlineRatings.com, Qatar Airways and Emirates are

joint third along with Cathay Pacific in the list of safest full-service airlines, followed by Etihad Airways at No. 5.

Air New Zealand is the world's safest full-service airline followed by Qantas, while HK Express is the world's safest low-cost carrier.

flydubai and Air Arabia, meanwhile, are among the safest low-cost carriers, according to the rankings.

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